

Dr. James Richardson

Principal Systems Architect | CEng Candidate

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Professional Summary

Accomplished Systems Architect with 12+ years of experience leading complex engineering programmes in financial services and critical infrastructure. Proven track record in delivering multi-million pound digital transformation initiatives, driving innovation, and building high-performing engineering teams. Extensive experience in enterprise architecture, cloud strategy, and emerging technologies. Committed to engineering excellence, sustainable development, and professional ethics.

Professional Experience

Principal Systems Architect

Apr 2021 – Present

Global Financial Services plc, London

- Lead architecture function for digital banking platform serving 8 million customers globally
- Direct team of 15 architects and technical leads across 4 geographical locations
- Spearheaded cloud migration programme (£25M budget) achieving 35% cost reduction and 99.99% availability
- Established enterprise architecture governance framework adopted across 6 business units
- Introduced Site Reliability Engineering practices reducing incident response time by 65%
- Present technical strategy to C-suite executives and board members quarterly
- Champion sustainability initiatives reducing data centre carbon footprint by 40%
- Mentor senior engineers through structured development programme; 3 promoted to architect roles

Senior Solutions Architect

Jun 2017 – Mar 2021

Enterprise Technology Partners, London

- Designed and delivered solutions for FTSE 100 clients across banking, insurance, and retail sectors
- Led architecture for real-time payments platform processing £2B daily transactions
- Developed reference architectures adopted as company standards for cloud-native applications
- Managed vendor relationships and technology selection for strategic accounts
- Conducted architecture reviews and provided technical assurance for major programmes
- Published internal white papers on microservices patterns and event-driven architecture

Technical Lead / Software Architect

Sep 2013 – May 2017

DataSystems International, Cambridge

- Progressed from Senior Developer to Technical Lead within 2 years
- Architected big data analytics platform handling 500TB+ of financial data
- Led team of 8 developers delivering mission-critical trading systems
- Introduced automated testing and continuous deployment practices
- Collaborated with research team on machine learning integration projects

Software Engineer

Jul 2011 – Aug 2013

Tech Innovations Ltd, Oxford

- Developed high-performance computing applications for scientific research
- Contributed to open-source projects and published technical articles

Education

PhD Computer Science – Distributed Systems2008 – 2011

Imperial College London

- Thesis: "Fault-Tolerant Consensus Algorithms for Large-Scale Distributed Systems"
- Published 4 peer-reviewed papers in leading journals

MEng Computer Science – First Class Honours2004 – 2008

University of Cambridge

- Specialisation in Software Engineering and Computer Architecture
- Master's project on real-time operating systems

Technical Expertise

Enterprise Architecture

Cloud Strategy (AWS/Azure/GCP)

Microservices

Event-Driven Architecture

Domain-Driven Design

Distributed Systems

Kubernetes

Infrastructure as Code

Java / Spring

.NET / C#

Python

Kafka

TOGAF

ArchiMate

Security Architecture

Professional Memberships & Certifications

- BCS, The Chartered Institute for IT – Fellow (FBCS) since 2022
- IET – Member (MIET) since 2015
- TOGAF 9.2 Certified Enterprise Architect (2020)
- AWS Solutions Architect Professional (2021)
- Google Cloud Professional Cloud Architect (2022)
- CISSP – Certified Information Systems Security Professional (2019)

Publications & Speaking

- "Building Resilient Financial Systems" – QCon London 2024 (Keynote Speaker)
- "Cloud-Native Patterns for Regulated Industries" – IEEE Software, 2023
- "The Future of Digital Banking Architecture" – BCS Webinar Series, 2022
- Regular contributor to company technical blog (20+ articles)

Key Achievements

- Led successful FCA regulatory compliance programme for open banking implementation
- Achieved AWS Well-Architected Framework certification for production workloads
- Winner, Company Innovation Award 2023 for AI-driven fraud detection architecture
- Patent pending: "Distributed Consensus Method for Real-Time Transaction Processing"

Continuing Professional Development

- Executive Leadership Programme – London Business School (2024, 5 days)
- Advanced Security Architecture – SANS Institute (2023, 40 hours)
- Sustainable IT Practices – Green Software Foundation (2023, 20 hours)

- BCS Architecture SG – Committee Member and regular presenter

References

Available upon request